

TACTIC-FP Annotation Cheatsheet

12 tactical intent classes + 2 exclusions. Use exact app labels. Segment every contiguous phase without overlap.

Non-Negotiable Annotation Gates

Gate	Rule	Why it matters
Duration	Each segment must be 2-15 seconds.	Shorter is rejected; longer must be split.
Coverage	Aim for ≥ 18 visible players, coverage ≥ 0.80 .	Below 0.80 should not be submitted for training.
Timeline	Segments must be contiguous and non-overlapping.	No gaps, no overlaps, no mixed phase blobs.
Exclusions	DeadBall and ContestedPlay carry no tactical team intent.	Clear both team labels when exclusion is selected.
Perspective	Annotate from the active team perspective.	If labeling both teams, each team can need a different intent.

Exact Labels And Hotkeys

Family	App label	Hotkey	Primary trigger
BUILDUP	BuildUp_Short	1	Own half / defensive third; controlled short passing.
BUILDUP	BuildUp_Long	2	Own half / defensive third; long pass launched forward.
BUILDUP	PossCirculation	Q	Established possession in middle/final third with no penetration.
ATTACK	CounterAttack	3	Won ball recently, immediate high-speed attack.
ATTACK	DirectAttack	W	Direct vertical attack by design, not necessarily after turnover.
PRESS	HighPress	4	Opponent has ball in their half; aggressive pressure.
PRESS	MidBlockPress	5	Opponent has ball near middle third; selective pressure.
PRESS	LowBlock	6	Opponent has ball; we defend deep near our goal.
TRANSITION	AttackingTrans	7	We have ball; moving from buildup/circulation into attack.
TRANSITION	DefensiveTrans	8	We lost ball; recovering or counter-pressing briefly.
SETPIECE	SetPieceAttack	9	Our organized restart: corner, free kick, throw-in, penalty.
SETPIECE	SetPieceDefend	0	Opponent organized restart.
EXCLUSION	DeadBall	R	Ball out, injury, substitution, referee stop, half-time.
EXCLUSION	ContestedPlay	T	50-50 duel, scramble, pinball, no team control.

Fast Decision Flow

Step	Question	If yes	If no
1	Is ball out of play, ref stopped, injury, substitution?	DeadBall.	Continue.
2	Is it a 50-50 scramble with no control?	ContestedPlay.	Continue.
3	Is this an organized restart?	SetPieceAttack if our restart; SetPieceDefend if opponent restart.	Open play: continue.
4	Who has possession?	If opponent has it, choose a defensive family.	If we have it, choose offensive/transition family.
5A	Opponent has ball: where is our defensive block?	High = HighPress; middle = MidBlockPress; deep = LowBlock.	If just lost ball and recovering, DefensiveTrans.
5B	We have ball: where and how?	Own third short/long = BuildUp_Short/BuildUp_Long; sideways established = PossCirculation.	If accelerating into attack, Attackin gTrans/CounterAttack/DirectAttack .
6	Did we just win possession and explode forward?	CounterAttack.	Direct vertical attack without recent turnover = DirectAttack.

Offensive Classes

When your active team has the ball. Do not assign these to the non-possessing team.

Label	Use when	Spatial cues	Temporal cues	Common confusion check
BuildUp_Short	Controlled progression from the back using short passes.	GK/CB/FB in own half; close support angles; triangles.	Patient, low tempo, multiple 5-20 m passes.	If already in middle/final third with sideways circulation, use PossCirculation.
BuildUp_Long	Progression starts at the back but the ball is launched long.	GK/defender sends ball to forwards/wings; lines bypassed.	One or two long passes; midfield skipped.	If launched from middle third as an attacking tactic, use DirectAttack.
PossCirculation	Team keeps ball and probes without immediate penetration.	Middle or final third; U-shaped circulation; sideways/backward passes.	Sustained 5+ s; tempo controlled.	If tempo suddenly rises or line is broken, split and switch to AttackingTrans.
AttackingTrans	Move from buildup/circulation into an attacking phase.	Ball progresses middle to final third; runners advance beyond block.	Brief 2-5 s; increasing tempo; not yet a shot/cross finish.	If caused by a recent defensive turnover and immediate sprint, use CounterAttack.
CounterAttack	Immediate attack after winning the ball.	Ball won in defensive/middle third; vertical pass into space; forwards sprint.	1-3 s after turnover; high speed toward goal.	Requires recent turnover. If not from turnover, use DirectAttack.
DirectAttack	Direct vertical attack by design, bypassing midfield.	Long through ball, early cross, striker target, minimal buildup.	Quick, vertical, but not necessarily after turnover.	If it starts from GK/defender in own half, use BuildUp_Long.

Offensive Split Triggers

Situation	Action
Circulation becomes vertical and line-breaking.	Split: PossCirculation -> AttackingTrans.
Slow attack after winning the ball takes more than 5 s to progress.	Do not call it CounterAttack. Use AttackingTrans or PossCirculation depending on tempo.
Long ball from GK/CB into striker.	BuildUp_Long if from own half; DirectAttack if from middle/attacking phase.
Shot/cross happens after transition.	End transition and start attack/end event segment as your protocol requires.

Defensive, Transition, Set Piece, Exclusion

Start with possession: if opponent has the ball, choose press/block/defensive transition unless it is a restart or exclusion.

Label	Use when	Spatial cues	Temporal cues	Common confusion check
HighPress	Aggressive pressure in opponent half.	Our defensive line near halfway or higher; forwards close GK/defenders.	Immediate pressure; clear triggers in opponent half.	If line drops to middle third, use MidBlockPress. If we win and attack, split to CounterAttack/AttackingTrans.
MidBlockPress	Selective pressure in middle third.	Line around center-circle zone; compact but not all-out.	Reactive pressing on bad touch, wide pass, backward pass.	If too high, HighPress. If deep near box, LowBlock.
LowBlock	Deep compact defense absorbing pressure.	Line near own penalty area; narrow shape; two banks.	Sustained; little/no pressing trigger.	If from dead-ball defensive setup, use SetPieceDefend until ball is played.
DefensiveTrans	We just lost ball and are recovering shape.	Players sprint back or counter-press; direction toward own goal.	Brief 1-4 s after turnover; chaotic.	If organized press emerges, split to HighPress or MidBlockPress.
SetPieceAttack	Our organized restart.	Ball placed; attacking runs/set routine; defensive marking visible.	Only setup and immediate restart phase.	Once ball is played and shape becomes open play, split to new phase.
SetPieceDefend	Opponent organized restart.	Goal area or target zone organized; zonal/man marking.	Only setup and immediate restart phase.	If open-play defending after the restart, switch to LowBlock/MidBlock/transition.
DeadBall	Any stop in play.	Ball out, injury, substitution, ref stop, half-time.	Segment ends when play resumes.	No tactical intent labels on either team.
ContestedPlay	No team has control.	Aerial duel, loose-ball scramble, pinball in box.	Usually 1-3 s.	If one team gains control, end exclusion and start tactical segment.

Defensive Location Shortcut

Block height	Approximate clue	Likely label
High	Opponent half; our line high; forwards press ball carrier.	HighPress
Middle	Center third; compact team shape; selective triggers.	MidBlockPress
Low	Own third / near box; narrow and compact; absorbing.	LowBlock

Quality Control And Reviewer Rules

Use these rules to avoid the most common annotation and export failures.

Confidence Guide

Score	Use when	Review action
5	Classic clear example; all or nearly all players visible.	Submit normally.
4	Clear class, one minor ambiguity.	Submit normally.
3	Could plausibly be one of two labels or coverage is only slightly above threshold.	Flag mentally or send to review if available.
2	Multiple possible labels; evidence weak.	Reviewer required before training export.
1	Barely able to tell.	Skip, exclude only if truly DeadBall/ContestedPlay, or send to review.

Pre-Submit Error Checklist

Check	Error to avoid	Correct action
Possession	HighPress or LowBlock selected for the possessing team.	Possessing team gets attacking/offensive label; non-possessing team gets defensive label.
CounterAttack	Using it for any fast direct play.	Require recent defensive turnover plus immediate forward attack.
Set piece	Keeping set-piece label after open play resumes.	Split at restart/open-play transition.
Coverage	Submitting 16 visible players as low confidence.	Wait for better view, adjust boundary, or do not submit for training.
Exclusion	DeadBall/ContestedPlay plus tactical labels.	Clear both team intents; assign model split excluded.
Timeline	One long mixed segment.	Split whenever possession, tempo, restart state, or tactical phase changes.

Common Misclassification Pairs

Pair	Deciding question
BuildUp_Short vs BuildUp_Long	Are passes short and connected, or is the ball launched long from the back?
BuildUp_Short vs PossCirculation	Is the team still starting from defensive third, or already established higher?
HighPress vs AttackingTrans	Opponent has ball = HighPress; we have ball = AttackingTrans.
MidBlockPress vs LowBlock	Where is the defensive line: middle third or own defensive third?
CounterAttack vs DirectAttack	Was there a turnover just before the attack?
SetPieceAttack vs SetPieceDefend	Which team is taking the restart?

Annotator Workflow

A compact operating procedure for consistent match-video labeling.

Step	Action	Output
1	Watch the candidate segment once at normal speed.	Understand possession, phase, and story.
2	Check exclusion first: dead ball or no team control.	DeadBall / ContestedPlay, or continue.
3	Check restart state.	SetPieceAttack / SetPieceDefend only during organized restart.
4	Identify active team possession and opponent state.	Correct attacking/defensive family.
5	Choose exact label using spatial + temporal cues.	One intent per team, or one exclusion.
6	Set start/end at phase boundaries.	2-15 s segment, no overlap/gap.
7	Set confidence and coverage.	Confidence 1-5; coverage ≥ 0.80 for training.
8	Run mental pre-submit checklist.	No possession conflicts, no set-piece leak, no mixed phase.
9	Submit, then create the next contiguous segment.	Clean timeline ready for export.

Programming And Model Assistance Targets

Feature	What it should show	Human decision it helps
Tracking overlay	Player dots, ball point, visible-player count, missing trackers.	Coverage and shape confidence.
Possession hint	Trajectory-based team A/B/contested estimate with confidence.	Avoid attack/defense mismatch.
Boundary suggestions	Turnovers, speed changes, restarts, ball-out moments.	Faster split points.
Candidate labels	Top 2-3 labels with short reasons, never auto-submit.	Faster taxonomy lookup.
Contradiction warnings	Example: CounterAttack without turnover; set-piece label in open play.	Catch errors before export.

Keyboard Reminders

Task	Keys
Play / pause	Space or K
Seek	J / L = -10s / +10s; Left / Right = -5s / +5s; Shift+Left / Shift+Right = -1s / +1s
Set segment boundary	I = start at playhead; O = end at playhead
Switch active team	A / B
Pick labels	1-9, 0, Q, W, R, T
Submit	Enter
Help / cancel	? / Esc